

Day 2 — Capstone Discovery + Compressed PRD

Activity packet for participant quads. Today's job: do compressed discovery on the Holocron problem (the Week-1 muscles in 1 day) and produce **PRD-light** — a 2-page version that captures sections 1–7 with the same discipline as Week 3 in a fraction of the time.

Where we are in the week

Day 1 locked the Holocron scope slice and installed the AI Spec pattern. Today is **Discovery + PRD-light**. The Week-1 customer-centric work is compressed into one day; Week-3's PRD work is compressed into the afternoon.

By 16:00, every quad has a 2-page PRD-light ready to hand off as input to tomorrow's compressed architecture work.

The compression discipline

Compressed work is not lower-quality work. It's **selective**: keep what's load-bearing, cut what's cosmetic. A compressed PRD covers:

- Section 1 Context (½ page)
- Section 2 Problem (½ page)
- Section 3 Goals + non-goals (½ page)
- Section 4 Scope (in/out table)
- Section 5 Solution sketch (½ page)
- Section 6 Top 6–8 Acceptance Criteria
- Section 7 Top 5 NFRs (one per category from Wk 3 D3)

That's 2 pages. Every word earns its place.

Inputs

- The discovery inputs gathered overnight + this morning
- The AI Spec template from Day 1

- The Pattern Library prompts from Weeks 2, 4, 5

Activity 1 — Compressed Customer Discovery

Format: Quad • 45 min • Block 1

Purpose

Compressed Week-1 work: ground in customer signal, name the persona, name the pain, name the journey friction.

Quad protocol

Step 1 — Synthesize what you know (20 min)

Each quad member shares the inputs they gathered. Pool into:

- **Direct customer signal** — interviews, support tickets, observation, data
- **Indirect signal** — public reviews, competitor analysis, internal Slack
- **What's missing** — be honest

Step 2 — Name the persona (10 min)

A compressed persona has 3 fields:

```
**Persona:** <role + segment>  
**Job-to-be-done:** <verb-based, in their language>  
**Why it's hard today:** <specific friction; quote a  
real customer if possible>
```

Example: "**Persona:** New B2B finance ops associate at a 200-person company. **Job-to-be-done:** Close the books each month without staying late on Friday. **Why it's hard today:** 'I spend Thursday night chasing 4 different teams for missing accruals — by the time they respond, I've forgotten what I asked.'"

Step 3 — Top 3 pain points + journey friction (10 min)

For the persona, list 3 specific pains. Each ranks on:

- **Severity** (how bad is it?)
- **Frequency** (how often does it happen?)
- **Addressability** (can our feature actually fix it?)

The pain that survives all three goes in the PRD.

Step 4 — Sanity check (5 min)

The quad reads what they have aloud. Does it sound like a real customer's life, or a generic SaaS persona?

Output

A 1-page **discovery summary** that becomes the input to PRD-light Sections 1–2.

Activity 2 — PRD-Light Sections 1–4

Format: Quad • 50 min • Block 2

Purpose

Draft sections 1–4 of the compressed PRD: context, problem, goals/non-goals, scope.

Quad protocol — applied with AI assistance

The Week-3 discipline holds. AI accelerates drafting but does not replace judgment.

Step 1 — Context + Problem (25 min)

Each quad member solo-drafts Section 1 and Section 2 first. Then quad picks the strongest.

AI assistance pattern (after the solo drafts):

Role: Editor for a TPM's PRD context section.
Context: <quad's draft Section 1 + the discovery summary>
Task: Tighten this section to $\frac{1}{2}$ page max. Preserve the customer quote. Preserve the strategic anchor. Cut anything that sounds like marketing language.
Constraints:
– Do not invent customer signal
– Flag any claim that needs source backing
Format: Tightened Section 1 + a "what I cut" note.

Step 2 — Goals + Non-goals (15 min)

3 goals; 2–3 non-goals. Same Week-3 discipline. Goals are user outcomes, not feature names.

Step 3 — Scope (in / out) (10 min)

A 2-column table. Default: cut aggressively to fit the 4-day capstone window.

What "good" looks like

- Section 1 fits ½ page; references at least one customer quote or data point
 - Section 2 names the persona's specific friction
 - Goals are outcomes, not features
 - Non-goals catch the most-likely scope creep
 - Scope-out is rich (capstone work is naturally narrowed)
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Activity 3 — PRD-Light Sections 5–7

Format: Quad • 50 min • Block 3

Purpose

Draft Section 5 solution sketch + Section 6 Acceptance Criteria + Section 7 NFRs.

Quad protocol

Step 1 — Section 5 Solution Sketch (10 min)

½ page. The user-visible flow + key surfaces + hard interactions. Does **not** specify implementation.

The "engineer's first three questions" test from Week 3 still applies.

Step 2 — Section 6 Acceptance Criteria (25 min)

6–8 ACs total. Coverage:

- 3 happy-path ACs
- 2 sad-path ACs
- 1 weird-path AC

Use the Given/When/Then form. Compressed = fewer ACs, not weaker ACs.

Step 3 — Section 7 NFRs (15 min)

Top 5 NFRs — one per category:

- 1 Performance NFR (latency target with defense)
- 1 Security NFR (auth/authz approach)

- 1 Accessibility NFR (the WCAG floor)
- 1 Observability NFR (the leading indicator from your outcome map)
- 1 Compliance NFR (the regime that applies)

Each NFR uses the Wk 3 template: requirement / defense / verification.

What "good" looks like

- Section 5 doesn't specify implementation
- Section 6 has happy/sad/weird coverage
- Section 7 has all 5 categories represented
- The whole document fits 2 pages

Activity 4 — AI Validation Pass + Day-3 Setup

Format: Quad • 55 min + Wrap • Block 4

Purpose

Run the validation pass on PRD-light. Set up Day 3's compressed architecture work.

The validation pass

Use the Week 5 Day 5 discipline. For PRD-light:

Role: Senior PM reviewing a compressed PRD.
 Context: <paste PRD-light Sections 1-7>
 Task: Identify 5 issues:

1. A claim that lacks evidence
2. A goal that's actually an output
3. A non-goal that's missing
4. An AC that's untestable or vague
5. An NFR that's boilerplate

Constraints:

- Be specific
- Suggest a concrete fix

Format: 5 numbered findings.

Adopt / defer / reject. Update PRD-light. Provenance log.

Day-3 setup (last 20 min of block)

Tomorrow you'll produce TCD-light + TMD-light + AI Spec v1.
Plan ahead:

1. **What architectural questions do you need an answer to?** List the 3 questions a senior architect would ask reading PRD-light. These become tomorrow's TCD-light Section 1 input.
2. **What systems / data / APIs are in scope?** Sketch the integration map you'll formalize tomorrow.
3. **What's the critical path?** Which of TCD-light / TMD-light / AI Spec must ship by EOD tomorrow vs Thursday?

Wrap (last 15 min)

Each quad shares:

- Their **persona's job-to-be-done** in one sentence
- The **AC** they're proudest of
- The **NFR** that worried them most

End-of-day checkpoint

Each quad ends Day 2 with:

- ✓ **Discovery summary** (1 page)
- ✓ **PRD-light Sections 1–7** (2 pages total)
- ✓ AI validation pass run on PRD-light
- ✓ Provenance log entry
- ✓ **Day-3 plan**: 3 architecture questions, integration sketch, critical path